

All You Need to Know About SALTSTACK

SaltStack or Salt is software to automate the management and configuration of any infrastructure or application at scale. All networking is planned around remote execution. This could be as basic as asking a remote Web server to show a static Web page, or as perplexing as utilising a shell session to intuitively give commands to a remote server. Salt architecture is used to execute commands remotely.

Salt allows users to unequivocally target and issue commands to several machines directly. It deploys a master which controls at least one minion. Commands are usually given from the master to a target bunch of minions, which execute the jobs sent by the master and afterwards send information back to the latter.

SaltStack is an open source, configuration management software

and remote execution engine. It is a command line tool, written in Python. SaltStack configuration management is simple. Salt uses the push model for executing commands through the SSH protocol. The configuration comprises YAML and Jinja templates. Salt is on par with Puppet, Chef and Ansible. Being a feature-rich system, it provides many benefits such as robust authentication, as well as secure,

fast, virtual machine automation, and infrastructure as data, not code.

SaltStack architecture

Figure 1 shows the key components of the Salt architecture.

This architecture is intended to work with multiple servers — from local networks to other deployments across different data centres. It comprises a basic server/client model with the required functionality

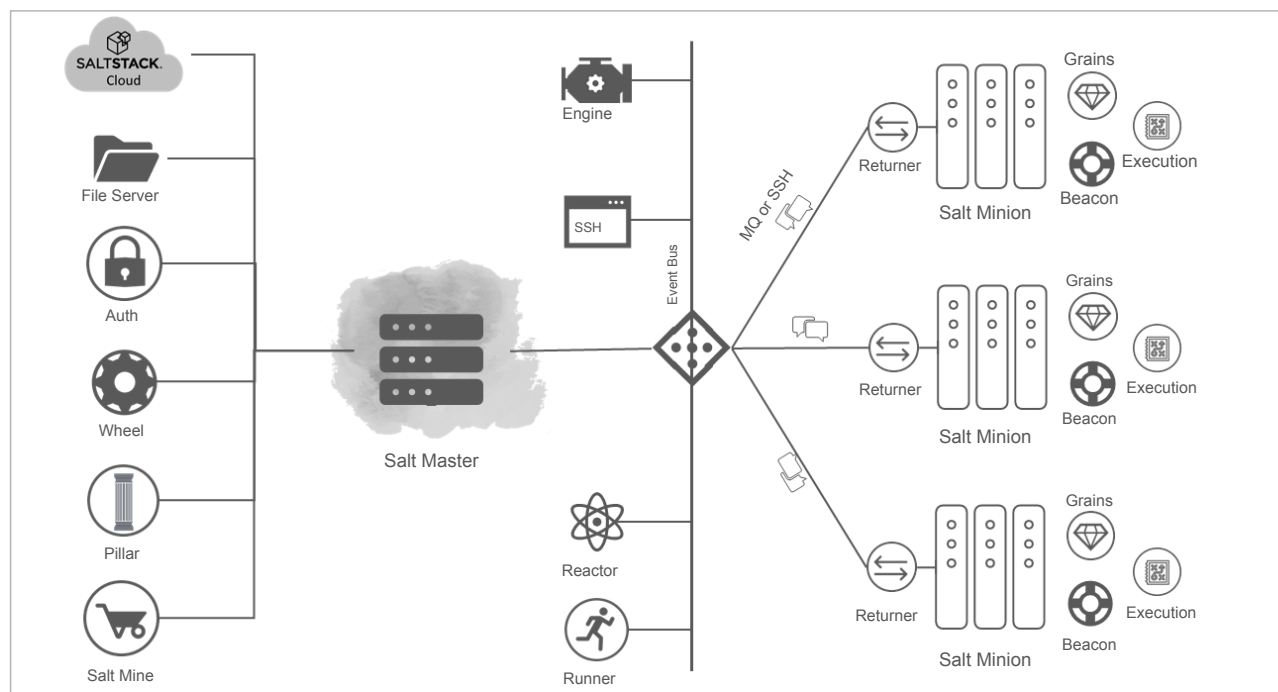


Figure 1: SaltStack architecture